MIL-B-36275A
20 February 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-36275(DM)
1 September 1964

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BOX, SHIPPING, HISTOPATHOLOGICAL SPECIMENS, Disposable

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of disposable, partitioned box containing 12 plastic screwcap jars, suitable for shipping small human specimens from medical activities to histopathological centers.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665	-	Boxes, Paperboard, Metal-Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-C-843	-	Cushioning Material, Cellulosic.
PPP-F-320	-	Fiberboard Corrugated and Solid Sheet Stock (Container Grade) and Cut Shapes.

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MILITARY

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center

20576 - Box, Shipping, Histopathological Specimens, Disposable.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Box. Body and cover of the box shall be constructed of 0.040 inch natural sulfate kraft fiberboard, conforming to style A of PPP-B-665.

3.1.2 Top, bottom pads, and partitions. Top, bottom pads, and partitions shall be fabricated from 200-pound test "B" flute, sulfate kraft corrugated fiberboard, conforming to type CF, class domestic of PPP-F-320.

3.1.3 Cushioning pad. Cushioning pad shall be absorbent, bleached, cellulose wadding, of 3/8-inch thickness of two 1/4-inch thicknesses (after standard weight is applied), conforming to type I, class A or B, and requirements and test procedures covering materials, thickness, absorbency, and tensile strength of PPP-C-843.

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3.1.4 Metal edge stays. Metal edge stays shall be 5/8-inch wide, conforming to the applicable portions of PPP-B-665.

3.1.5 Screwcap plastic jar.

3.1.5.1 Plastic jar. Jar shall be fabricated from white, opaque, rigid, linear polyethylene plastic material or a copolymer of polypropylene and linear polyethylene.

3.1.5.2 Closure. The screwcap closure shall be made of tinplate sheet metal.

3.1.5.3 Liner. Screwcap closure shall be fitted with a liner of resilient pulp or newsboard backing with a waxed coating or faced with vinyl or polyvinylidene chloride film.

3.2 Construction. The disposable shipping box shall be constructed as specified in 3.1.1 and in strict accordance with Drawing 20576. The box shall be of rectangular design with full-telescoping cover. All corners shall be firmly secured with metal edge stays. The box shall include two corrugated fiberboard inserts (top and bottom) and partitions (see 3.1.2) of the same material to form 12 compartments for containing 12 screwcap jars, and an absorbent cushioning pad (see 3.1.3). The box shall be completely assembled and shall consist of the following component parts:

a. Outer box and cover.
b. Top and bottom liner pads.
c. Partitions.
d. Cellulose absorbent pad.
e. Screwcap jars (twelve).

3.2.1 Box. The four corners of the body and cover of the box shall be secured by metal-edge stays attached so that all pronged eyelets of the stays shall be securely embedded in the corner walls of the cover and bottom to provide a firm box. The body and cover of the box shaft shall fit closely without undue binding. The inserts (liner pads, partitions, and absorbent cushioning pad) shall make a suitable fit on the inside of the body of the box. The assembled jars shall be suitably accommodated in the nested partitions to afford a minimum of jostling.

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3.2.2 Liner pads (top and bottom). One top and one bottom liner pad shall be provided for each box, as shown on the drawing.

3.2.3 Partitions. Partitions shall be provided for each box to form 12 compartments as shown on the drawing. The corrugated strips shall be slotted to form a firm nested partition. Strips shall not be loose or easily separated.

3.2.4 Cushioning pad. A cushioning pad shall be furnished in each box and shall consist of a number of plies of absorbent, bleached, cellulose wadding (see 3.1.3), providing a pad with a thickness of 3/8 inch or two 1/4-inch thicknesses (see PPP-C-843). The cushioning pad shall be positioned between the bottom liner pad and nested partition to prevent delamination. Embossed marking shall not penetrate the cushioning pad.

3.2.5 Screwcap plastic jar. Screwcap jar shall be a symmetrically made squat-type plastic jar with a metal screwcap in place, in accordance with the drawing. Screwcap shall be provided with a resilient pulp liner or newsboard backing with facing (see 3.1.5.3). Twelve screwcap jars shall be supplied.

3.2.5.1 Plastic jar. The jar shall be a round, wide-mouth, squat-type jar, with a nominal 4-ounce capacity, in accordance with the drawing. The jar shall have well-defined and properly made threads to receive the closure suitably. The jar shall accept and retain adhesive backed labels and imprints from marking pencils.

3.2.5.2 Screwcap closure. Closure shall be a tinplate sheet metal screwcap, lacquer-coated on the inside and black enamel-finished on the outside to resist corrosion. The screwcap shall be of the screw-on type, and shall be sufficiently threaded with a continuous-type thread to make a close fit with the jar. The metal cap shall have a rolled edge and shall be provided with a liner as specified in 3.1.5.3.

3.2.5.2.1 Liner. Closure shall be fitted with a liner as specified in 3.1.5.3. The liner shall be of sufficient thickness to form an effective seal with the mouth edge of the jar. There shall be no evidence of leakage of fluid content from the jar, when the jar is tested as specified in 4.4.1.

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3.3 Identification marking. Each shipping box shall have printed, on the inside surface of the cover, the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer. The outer bottom surface of each plastic jar shall have molded, in raised letters, the name or registered trademark of the manufacturer. The inside surface of the body and cover of each box shall be clearly marked with the National Stock Number (NSN).

3.4 Workmanship. The complete shipping box and component parts shall be clean, well made, and free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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4.1.3 Certificate of quality. Certificate of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the fiberboards, pads or jars, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the Item Identification, the name of the component/ material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as specified in table I.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination		
Major defects	II	2.5
Minor defects	II	10.0
For dimensional examination	S-3	2.5

4.2.1.1 Unit of product for examination. The unit of product for examination shall be the individual shipping box or individual jar as applicable. No more than 4 jars shall be selected from an individual shipping box.

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as specified in table II.

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TABLE II. Sampling for tests.

Component (unit of product)	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL
Screwcap jar	Leakage	3.2.5.2.1	4.4.1	S-3	0

4.2.2.1 Unit of product for testing. The unit of product for testing shall be the individual jar. No more than 4 jars shall be selected from an individual shipping box.

4.3 Examination. The box, all components, and jars shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination for defects shall include but shall not be limited to those listed in table III.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Components missing.
102	Box and partitions not free of deformation.
103	Box and fiberboard inserts not free of tears, cuts, holes, splits, and punctures.
104	Box not free of scoring cuts through paperboard.
105	All corners of cover and body of box not properly secured with metal edge stays.
106	Metal edge stays do not completely secure sides of box to form sturdy corner.
107	Metal stays not coated to resist corrosion.
108	Box and liner inserts not free of crushed, ragged or uneven edges.
109	Marking incomplete, illegible or missing.
110	Plastic jars not free of cracks, chips and breaks.
111	Threads of jar and cap not free of distortion and stripping, or incomplete and not clean cut.
112	Threads of jar and cap not continuous type or do not mate.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects. - Continued

Categories	Defects
Major	
113	Metal screwcaps not coated inside and outside to resist corrosion.
114	Corrugated fiberboard not free of ply separation.
115	Screwcap liners not coated or faced as specified.
116	Cushioning pad not free of ply separation.
117	Surface of jar does not accept adhesive-backed labels and imprints from marking pencils.
Minor	
201	Box and liner inserts not free of scuff on either facing.
202	Box and liner inserts not free of wrinkles and unspecified creases or folds.
203	Identification marking missing, incorrect or incomplete.
204	Cushioning material not free of tears, holes and cuts.
205	Jars not clean, dry, or free of dirt and foreign matter.
206	Jars not free of protrusions, indentations, sharp edges and rough seams.
207	Mouth edges of jars not even and smooth.
208	Jars not free of deformed areas.
209	Rolled edge not present on screwcap.
210	Partitions not firm; strips loose and easily separated.

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The box, all components, and jars shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

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4.3.3 Examination for preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table IV. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. Examination for preparation for delivery.

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Leakage test. The plastic jar shall be tested for leakage by filling the jar with water and screwing the cover on tight. The jar shall be inverted and allowed to stand 1/2 hour before examining for evidence of leakage beyond the seal.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation-packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Unit package shall not be required.

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5.1.1.2 Intermediate package. Four boxes shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and design. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Twenty boxes (5 intermediate packages) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Special requirements as specified in the applicable table of PPP-B-636 shall apply for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed in accordance with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty boxes (5 intermediate packages) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Special requirements as specified in the applicable table of PPP-B-636 shall apply for fiberboard boxes. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method I or II as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Intermediate packages. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. The National Stock Number of the item.
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 This specification is applicable to the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6640-00-889-1594	BOX, SHIPPING, HISTOPATHOLOGICAL SPECIMENS, Disposable

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:
DSA-DM

Project No. 6640-0927

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OMB Approval No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-B-36275A BOX, SHIPPING, HISTOPATHOLOGICAL SPECIMENS, Disp

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY (Printed or typed name and address - Optional)

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